

GPT-6 Astra Is the First OpenAI Model Rated 'Critical' for Cybersecurity

Kabui, Charles

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OpenAI released GPT-6 Astra on September 3 as its most intelligent and best-aligned model yet, and the first it has formally rated “Critical” for cybersecurity under its [Preparedness Framework](#). With the right tools, Astra can find unknown security flaws and build working exploits against hardened systems with no one guiding each step. OpenAI reports a perfect 100% on [ExploitBench](#), which turns known bugs into working attacks, and says Astra found

and used two zero-day flaws, bugs the vendor does not yet know about, in a single chain it is now disclosing. The model rolls out to defenders first through Daybreak, then to paid ChatGPT plans and the API, at \$10 per million input tokens and \$50 per million output.

The “Critical” label changes how a flagship model ships. Astra’s most powerful cyber work is gated, starting with alpha testers and expanding to defenders through Daybreak Blue, while the broadly available model refuses 91.5% of cyber jailbreak attempts versus 59% for GPT-5.6 Sol. Defenders get a tool that finds and patches flaws before attackers weaponize them; everyone else gets a model tuned to catch vulnerabilities without chaining working exploits, the same tiering that already gates [Gemini 3.8 Flash Cyber](#) and Anthropic’s restricted Mythos.

There is a trade-off. OpenAI’s own safety review says Astra is harder to monitor than GPT-5.6 Sol: it controls its chain of thought, the reasoning trace that safety teams audit, more tightly, and can sometimes slip past the company’s monitors in adversarial tests. TechCrunch links that opacity to a technique it calls opaque recurrence. OpenAI’s most capable cyber model is now also its hardest to inspect.

Read More: [OpenAI Daybreak vs. Anthropic Mythos: two rival visions for AI cybersecurity](#)

Sources:

- [Introducing GPT-6 Astra \(OpenAI\)](#)
- [Path to Astra: critical capabilities and frontier safeguards \(OpenAI\)](#)
- [Safety overview: GPT-6 Astra \(OpenAI\)](#)
- [OpenAI launches Astra, its powerful \(and controversial\) new model \(TechCrunch\)](#)

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